Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣10

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣4

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦3

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣5

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 9 3
♦ K Q 8
♣ A K J 2

♠ J 10 9 5 3
♥ 8
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q 7 3



♠ A Q 2
♥ 10 6
♦ 6 5 4
♣ 10 8 6 5 4

♠ 7 4
♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2
♦ A 9 2
♣ 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣10

After NORTH opens 2NT, SOUTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the NORTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding NORTH might have.

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4 3
♥ A 9 4
♦ Q 9 3
♣ A Q 3

♠ K 9 8 5
♥ Q 7
♦ K 8 7
♣ J 9 6 5



♠ A 6
♥ K J 5 3
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ K 10 7

♠ J 10 2
♥ 10 8 6 2
♦ J 10 2
♣ 8 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			

2NT by East
Lead: ♣4

WEST has an invitational hand, (9 points), after EAST's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

EAST then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, WEST can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which EAST declines.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 7 5
♥ Q J 6
♦ A K 5 2
♣ Q 10 9

♠ Q J 3
♥ 10 9 8 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ K 3 2



♠ 10 2
♥ 7 4
♦ Q 10 7 4
♣ A J 8 7 5

♠ K 9 8 6 4
♥ A K 5 3
♦ J 8
♣ 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♦3

Because SOUTH holds a 4-card Major suit, (♥s), he starts his responses with Stayman.

NORTH denies holding any 4-card Major suit so SOUTH gives up on ♥s. He next bids ♠s, showing five of them. He jumps to 3♠, giving NORTH the choice between 4♠ or 3NT.

With three trumps NORTH chooses 4♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 9 ♥ A 10 8 5 ♦ K 10 8 7 ♣ A 10 3	
♠ A K 7 3 ♥ Q J 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ K Q J 6		♠ Q 8 6 5 ♥ K 7 6 4 ♦ A 3 2 ♣ 5 4
	♠ 10 4 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ Q 9 6 4 ♣ 9 8 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♠J

EAST has a poor 9 points, but does have two 4-card Majors. So he uses Stayman.

When WEST bids ♠s, EAST isn't strong enough to bid game herself, so she temporizes with a 3♠ invitation.

WEST has a full 17 points so he accepts the invitation.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q
♥ A Q 7 5
♦ K 10 9
♣ Q J 8 4

♠ A 3 2
♥ K J
♦ J 8 4
♣ A K 9 6 3



♠ 9 4
♥ 10 8 6 4 3 2
♦ 7 6 3 2
♣ 5

♠ J 10 8 7 6 5
♥ 9
♦ A Q 5
♣ 10 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣5

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 6-card suit, knows they should play in ♠s. The question is: how high?

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♠s, then invites by raising to 3♠.

NORTH has only two trumps, (good ones, admittedly), but she has a maximum 17 point hand. So she bids the ♠ game.